Creamy Tomato & Basil Chicken

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Sweet cherry tomatoes, fresh basil and a splash of balsamic vinegar make a beautiful sauce for chicken.

Serves 4 · Prep 10 min · Cook 25 min

INGREDIENTS

- 4 chicken breasts, approximately 700–800 g in total
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 500 g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 1 tsp brown sugar
- ¼–½ tsp chili flakes, to taste
- 1 tbsp balsamic vinegar
- 200 g crème fraîche
- 1 generous handful fresh basil leaves, roughly torn, plus extra to finish
- Salt, to taste

METHOD

1. Prepare the chicken. Pat the chicken breasts dry. If they are very thick, slice horizontally into thinner cutlets so they cook evenly. Season lightly with salt.
2. Sear the chicken. Heat the olive oil in a large frying pan over medium-high heat. Add the chicken and cook until golden on both sides, working in batches if necessary. Transfer to a plate; it will finish cooking in the sauce.
3. Cook the tomatoes. Reduce the heat to medium. Add the cherry tomatoes to the same pan with the brown sugar, chili flakes and a little salt. Cook for approximately 5–7 minutes, stirring occasionally, until softened and releasing their juices.
4. Add the balsamic vinegar and stir, scraping up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan. Let it bubble briefly.
5. Make the creamy sauce. Reduce the heat to low and stir in the crème fraîche until combined with the tomato juices.
6. Return the chicken and any collected juices to the pan. Simmer gently for approximately 5–8 minutes, depending on thickness, until the chicken is cooked through.
7. Fold in the torn basil leaves. Taste and adjust the salt, then finish with a few fresh basil leaves and serve.

Tip

Keep the chicken an even thickness. This helps it cook evenly and stay tender.